

Google Play Store 3.9.16

The new Play store has features like remove items from all app list, Jelly Bean expanded notification system and more



Flickr rewards faithful users

Yahoo's "Flickr" has rewarded its long time loyal users with a 3-month Pro subscription, unlimited storage, unlimited viewing and posting photos in 60 groups

Industry Connect

What's up, HP?

Vinay Awasthi, Sr. Director, HP India, talks about their latest Envy X2 hybrid PC, delayed India product launches and other prickly issues

Siddharth Parwatay

siddharth.parwatay@thinkdigit.com

How has HP been innovating from a personal systems standpoint?

HP has a huge history of innovation in a variety of products. From the printing side most of the innovations in ink and laser is proprietary HP. On the commercial side we have thin-clients that draw power over Ethernet cable and many other innovations. We have also put a lot of effort in coming up with some new technology based on the Intel roadmap.

What are the innovations on the Envy X2?

With the X2, we have put batteries in both the base unit as well as the screen and when you operate without a power connection, the base unit battery is used first. So even after using it for 7-8 hours, when you remove the screen portion and use it as a tablet, it still has another 8 hours of battery life. So together you have 17 to 18 hours of battery life.

Is the Envy X2 a mass market device or is it a geeky product – something that only enthusiasts or early adopters would go for?

Any product of this nature starts off with a high price. Even Ultrabooks started off with a high price point, right? As the usage of such products grow, the cost will come down.

Since X2 is like a tablet as well, will HP bundle any cloud storage utility with it?

At this moment we're not bundling anything per se. As of now the X2 has enough storage. If I look at my laptop I can say that I don't need cloud storage because there is enough space in the hard drive itself.

With Microsoft's Surface devices, has it affected their relation with players like HP?

I haven't seen Surface to be honest, and from whatever I've heard, I don't think it has impacted anything between HP and Microsoft. It's just one of the devices that's been introduced. I think it's going to be an interesting time for Microsoft to get into the hardware business.

You don't see it eating into the PC pie?

I don't think so. I hope it does well for them because it will only help establish the overall category. One product doesn't on its own succeed. Usually, there are two, three successful stories and it grows a category far bigger. I don't feel threatened by it all. In fact Microsoft will try to put in a huge amount of effort to create awareness for the category which will benefit everyone involved.

Coming back to the Envy X2 who is HP targeting exactly with this product?

If I look at it two or three years down the line, I believe these products will become mainstream products. But initially people considering a tablet and a notebook at the upper-end of the consumer notebook spectrum will go for this. And in the corporate sales we believe the CXO domain will definitely want these kinds of products strong reasons: it's Windows and easier to integrate into the corporate environment, it's a notebook for work and tablet as a consumption device.

We've seen a couple of devices that were radically innovative but remained proof of concept devices because of a critical flaw. Do you have a comment on this?

I'll let you judge the Envy X2 from your own perspective.

Worldwide launches have started to catch on. So why is it that products get launched in the U.S. but in the Indian market it gets launched a month later or



Vinay Awasthi Sr. Director - Product Category, Printing and Personal Systems Group, HP India

so? What do you say to customers who don't like waiting for products?

When you look at it, one month here and there is not a big deal.

As the traditional digital divide or information gap reduces, people here know about the products that are being launched abroad. They are going to want to get their hands on them and these thought leaders are the first to purchase these products but they never get to. And a lot of brands have started launching simultaneously. So why is HP lagging here?

India is now one of the top few countries in the world in terms of product launches. Sequencing of launches happens for a variety of reasons because the versions required to adapt it to specific countries whether it is the power cord, whether it is software, whether it is language... they do require work.

Does HP have some kind of policy of not participating in comparison tests? If so why is that?

I will have to find out more about this. I am not completely up to speed on this issue. Let me take that as a follow up item.